

The Power of Private Worship to Sustain You

Open to Ephesians 5.

How many of you have noticed a change that seems to be coming our way? Of course the devil is kicking, but I am talking about the other change. Do you know what it is?

The prayer center is becoming more and more a family, not a religion.

In all my life serving Him, preaching meetings, traveling all over the church in the earlier days, I have never felt anything like this. There was a lot of excitement, but it was generally God to us and what He was doing for us. It was hardly ever what people were doing for one another.

I do not mind telling you, I am excited. When you see something like that, it is not common. It is just not common.

Some things belong to Him, and all the glory is one of those things.

I have found that private worship has a ferocious sustaining power in whatever you are going through.

Stand up. It is a great day. Lift those hands. You are alive. You have a commission in front of you, and it is a great commission. What a good day to be alive. What a generation to pass through. He saved you for the last.

Did He know when you were going to be born? He did. You did not, but He did.

Think about what you get to do. We live at a time when information is at your fingertips. Entire translations, Greek tools, and every form of Bible study are available. The Word has never been so available. Nothing can hide from us now. If I need to know something, I get a kid with a computer.

Paul said, "Because of the abundance of my revelation." As for abundance now, we live in a time when we can know almost anything.

So throw those hands up:

Father, I worship You and glorify You with all my heart.

I magnify, extol, and exalt You.

I bless the day You saved me.

Father, I glorify, magnify, and lift You up with all my heart.

Thank You, Father.

I know You love me, and I love You.

I give You the glory, praise, and honor.

In Jesus' precious name.

Everybody said amen.

There has been a lot of talk lately about fasting and worship as tools or keys. God gave a proclamation around the first quarter of this year about fasting, and He will let us know when anything changes. Meanwhile, stay on a schedule if at all possible.

We have preached on all different kinds of fasting, including some serious fasting.

People say, "I am going to lock myself up and fast." I used to long for the day I would be off my job so I could accomplish my first long fast. You do not know how many years that took. I thought the fight would be over when I got to go to a room and lock myself in.

My God, do you know who I ran into?

Me.

I could not get away either. It was horrible. I wished I was hoeing, shoveling, doing something to get my mind off it.

Finally I broke into my first longer fast. I just lay on the bed numb.

Another time, Rosalie went to Paris with a doctor friend, and I said, "What a perfect time for that lock-up long fast I have been wanting to do." We made a pact that I would not break it without calling her. I called all of France and could not get hold of her. I started begging a little, but it did no good. You have to know Rosalie.

I went on that fast, and I could not break it because I had promised her. But the lock-up did not last long. Pretty soon I crawled out of bed, turned on the television, and watched it for twenty-two days. I had to keep my mind on something.

How do I remember twenty-two days? Because on the twenty-second day, something broke. I was all right. I gained control over something. The next one was not quite as hard, though I do not think I have ever had one that I just skipped through with no difficulty.

If you are graced with that kind of time, trust me when I say you do not know what you are getting into. It is like being locked up with a wild beast.

Isaiah 58 says, "Is not this the fast that I have chosen?" It talks about undoing heavy burdens and setting captives free. Then suddenly it says, "that thou hide not thyself from thine own flesh."

I tried to analyze that through the Word I knew. Did it mean that because Jesus said to wash your face and not appear to men to fast? No. What did it mean?

The day you decide to fast is the day you decide to stop hiding from whatever has been keeping you from moving forward.

That is why Isaiah says, "hide not thyself from thine own flesh." Trust me, there is no place you can hide. It will find you.

Gary called fasting the scourging post, and it is. You will face just about anything of the flesh that wants to stop you. Eventually you will face it somewhere in that fast, because fasting uncovers it.

In my first few fasts, Rosalie asked, "Are you going away to fast?"

I said, "No, I will fast at home."

She said, "No, go. Part of the time, you might not be yourself."

When you break through and start succeeding in fasting, it is tremendous. The flesh loses control of you. You can pray as much as you want during the times you can pray, without the flesh dominating you.

Romans says, "If Christ be in you, the body is dead because of sin; but the Spirit is life because of righteousness."

Positionally, your body has been declared dead because of what it inherited from the first Adam. Positionally, your spirit is seated with Christ in heavenly places. When you fast, you enforce a position you already have: the body is positionally dead and does not have the power to dominate your born-again spirit.

This is what fasting does. It positions the flesh in the place already prepared for it.

Why did I open to the worship chapter? Because one of the things that helped me go through the worst of fasting was worship.

Gary taught about the time I was submerged deeply in rest and peace, and it started manifesting in the services. That time was earmarked by a lock-up I had done. They rented a room for me, and I locked myself in it.

It seemed that the devil knew a breakthrough was coming. History is full of people who have gone this way before. There is nowhere we have gone that somebody else has not gone before us. The devil has had a map to study. He knows when someone reaches certain places, and he knows what he tries to do to stop them.

This time, it seemed like a presence showed up in the room that resisted me head to toe. Everything I knew, I threw against it. It resisted me day after day. But I would not stop, because the part of the flesh he was trying to rekindle had already been dealt with. He could not make me stop, nor could he run me out of the room.

I stayed in there and plowed.

It was one of the driest times I had ever spent. He tried to convince me God was not there, but that was a bald-faced lie.

Jesus cried on the cross, "My God, My God, why hast Thou forsaken Me?" He had to, because He was there in your place. But as your Substitute, He made sure that God would never forsake you. I do not care what your emotions say. He is still there. You have to know that.

I remember lying on that bed with my arms up, worshiping God against the stream. The devil tried to tell me He was not there. He might as well have left on the first day.

Then something came over me. I jumped off the bed, lifted my hands, and went down at an angle with my hands up. Then I came up, threw them back up, and went down the other way. It was like electricity filled the room.

Not long after that, Gary was standing nearby. I walked up to him, put my hands up, and he said, "What is pushing on me?"

I loved worship because it helped sustain me through the worst parts, and victory came much more quickly over the flesh when I coupled fasting with worship. Worship helped my senses and emotions stay in place for however long it took.

The fight with worship was much shorter than the fight with my flesh when I was trying to bring it under ascendancy.

Whatever it takes, I do not care. He paid for it. We are going to hand Tulsa up to Him whether the devil likes it or not.

If you continue in fasting, maybe you fast a couple of days and eat a day, or fast a day and eat a day, or go a couple of days and wait until you know you will go again. Stay open. He wants to do something. If it were up to Him alone, it would have already been done.

God is not happy just babysitting a crowd through to heaven, though that is acceptable and good in God. He wants the primary objective out there, the reason He died.

Do you think I am going to get so wrapped up in my problems that I do not fulfill the commission He gave me?

Ephesians 5:17 says:

"Wherefore be ye not unwise,
but understanding what the will of the Lord is."

Then:

"And be not drunk with wine,
wherein is excess;
but be filled with the Spirit."

Then He tells you how:

"Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns
and spiritual songs,
singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;
Giving thanks always for all things
unto God and the Father
in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ."

Who are you speaking to? Yourself.

When I am worshiping God, I am ministering to myself. I am making melody in my heart to the Lord, giving thanks for all things to God and the Father.

Does "all things" mean car wrecks and disease? No. You only have to go back to verse 17: understand what the will of the Lord is. Give thanks for the things contained in His will.

The alternative to being drunk with wine is to be filled with the Spirit. For years the revelation in that was hidden from me, because when I would go into the Spirit, my senses would get numb and I would be submerged in the Spirit. People would say, "He is drunk on the Spirit," and I thought that was exactly what the verse meant.

But He is giving instruction on how to be filled with the Spirit in the way He is talking about: ministering to yourself in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, making melody in your heart to the Lord.

Here is one of my favorite proclamations:

You are not a man that You can lie.
You have exalted Your Word above Your name.
Heaven and earth will pass away,
but Your Word abides forever.
I have what I say.
I call myself dead,
that I may separate to You all the glory, praise, and honor.
I operate in the fullness of Your grace.
The blind see, the lame walk, and the dead are raised now.
I owe no man anything but to love him.

When He showed me this verse, it opened up something. I had gone to Oklahoma City for a passion play. It was good as far as props went. They had spared nothing. Angels flew on wires. Hell was hot, and it burned. Everyone had their cues, and they sang well. But there was not much

anointing.

On the way back, I was thinking, "What could a person do to bring anointing into something like that?"

He said, "You could find out if you would go home and worship Me all night."

Did I? No. I did not want to find out that badly.

A year later, I fell out under the power here, and He said, "You do not know anything about worship." Then He began giving instructions. When I locked myself up, He even gave me the hours because He knew I was stubborn enough that if I knew He said it, I would do it.

On the way back from Oklahoma City, I had seen a small vision of a rock landing in a pond. I saw ripples go to every shoreline. The first ripple was my spirit full of worship. The second ripple was the baptism of the soul and the emotions. The third ripple was the geographical location, the presence becoming so overpowering that it overflowed into the geography around me.

How many remember when we experienced that outpouring and cried and cried?

Spirit, soul, then body and geography.

What does it mean to be filled with the Spirit by ministering to yourself?

When someone gets drunk, their senses are impaired. Wally Cox could get drunk, walk into a bar, and think he could whip Arnold Schwarzenegger. Why? Because he is not evaluating things in the light they exist in. His senses are impaired by alcohol.

How does that work in the Spirit? My senses, my emotions, become baptized. When I broke into this, it took half the fight away. The baptism of the senses began to take place.

I would look at a mountain and say, "I know that is a mountain, but I cannot seem to evaluate it in the light it exists in naturally. My senses must be impaired."

Yes, in the right direction. I was filled enough to think that God and I could go move the mountain.

When I look at a problem that says, "You cannot win," I say, "Oh yes, I can win." I am not evaluating things in the light they exist in naturally. I am evaluating them in the light they exist in with God.

And it feels good.

If you are going to break into private worship, put at least an hour aside to start.

Some taught about a "quiet place" and called it soaking. There is nothing wrong with soaking in His presence, but there is a real quiet place.

It took me a while to enter it through worship. At first my mind would wander off. I would be saying, "I love You, I worship You, I praise You," while my mind went on a trip. When I discovered it, I would pull my mind back and try to focus it on Him. A few minutes later it would wander down another street. I spent a lot of time pulling it back.

Eventually I came ahead of schedule. I got to where I could just lie there, and that is when I started entering what you would classify as a quiet place. My mind was no longer looking to go anywhere. His presence was so enjoyable that I wanted to stay right there.

Others who broke into private worship went another way. Even if their minds wandered, they did not try to control them. They just kept worshipping, while their minds wandered around solving problems. Eventually the law of confession took over. You cannot say something enough without beginning to believe it yourself. Every one of them eventually came to the place where they could worship without going on those side trips, simply by not quitting the language of worship.

I fought my way in. They confessed their way in. Both worked.

That is the way we are built. Tell me something about your soul. Why can you not read a paragraph, close the book, and quote it word for word, comma for comma? Some can, because they have photographic memories. But most of us cannot.

Yet if you read it several times and take notes, you can do it. If you can do it after several times, you had the capacity. So why not the first time? Something has to happen in there.

If I want to offer my soul on the altar of God's Word, I use those principles.

Take a book. Start with smaller ones: Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians. Assimilate the book. Make a point of reading it thirty times. First, if there is a word you do not understand, look it up. But do not stop and break verses down yet.

As you read, sections of meaning come together. One section causes you to understand another. One verse triggers another. Finally, the mind of Christ comes forward in the book. Then you find it in another book, and the books agree.

This is the way your mind works, and you can harness it.

So when it comes to fasting, worship is a powerful tool to sustain yourself during the onslaughts of the flesh. Once you break in, fasting becomes much easier in the future. You, working with God, bring the flesh under ascendancy.

I believe a great outpouring is coming.

How about praying in tongues? I can do that. My mind can assimilate while I do that. I can pray in tongues while working under my breath. I can do it any time.

Why? Because I am not in charge of what I am saying. God is so smart that He left you out of it so He could do your praying for you. He knows what is best for you.

He that searches the heart knows the mind of the Spirit, God's will for you now and His entire plan. Because He knows it concerning you as an individual, He enables the Spirit to make intercession for you according to the will of God. Then you can know He will work all things together for good until you walk down that path of victory and revival.

What a golden key. God evaluated you and said, "I will create this prayer in you. Since your spirit prays, it will really be you and your authority doing the praying. I will supply My plan, you will pray it out, and I will answer it."

"I cannot speak with tongues."

If you want to, come up here.

How many of you are going to fast a little more than you used to? How many will offer that old soul on the altar of God's Word a little more than you used to?

That is how it works.

A five-year-old missionary child does not climb out on the airplane wing and proclaim, "I will learn the language of this country." He does not have to. Every attribute of the soul reaches out and assimilates the language. Mind, will, intellect, and emotion all work together.

Most of our problem is that when we want to learn something new, we employ only one attribute: the intellect. There are three more lying in the wings, ready to transform you. Find out how to employ them. They are yours.

The same thing goes into operation with healing. You cannot call yourself healed a thousand times a day for any amount of time without eventually believing it. You assimilate it. Mind, will, intellect, and emotion reach out and make it part of you.

If you are believing for anything else, He is here. Tell Him. When He is present in this kind of way, all that He is is available: workings of miracles, gifts of healings, and all the rest. He will flow into your agreement and do what He does.

Get clear in your heart what you are asking for. Know it, so when it comes to pass, you will know.

If I will speak with the Spirit, I will speak with the understanding also. Many of you have been praying in seasons, edifying yourself and praying yourself to places. At times, when you are close, I use My grace, the standing I gave to you, and I am able to move things forward or come in on them.

This brings you closer to your heart's call, to bring to pass what I commissioned you for.